The Quillen-Casteel Family

Maternal Generations of Appalachia

A Genealogical Deep Research Report
for Jason B. Horne

170 direct maternal ancestors across 15 generations
anchored at Kathy Eileen Quillen (b. 1954, Gate City, Scott Co VA)

April 2026

Executive Summary

This report traces Jason B. Horne's maternal line, the Quillen and Casteel families of Scott County, Virginia, through 15 generations and 170 direct ancestors. Where the paternal Horne line arrived at a Sussex Quaker origin and a Kalmar Nyckel Swedish thread, the maternal line tells a different Appalachian story: Irish through the Quillens, Flemish-French through the Casteels, Scots-Irish Ulster through the Doughertys and Berrys, and Palatine German through the Diehls. Nearly every ancestor born between 1800 and 1900 lived and died in Scott County or its immediate neighbors.

Headline Findings

- Quillen immigrant ancestor identified: Teague Quillin, age 20, arrived Virginia 21 August 1635 aboard the ship Thomas under Capt. Henry Tavener. The American line is 200 years older than the Surry NC → Scott VA migration suggests.
- Casteel origin is Flemish, not Palatine German: descent from Capt. Edmond du Chastel de Blangerval, who settled in Philadelphia circa 1692-93. The family was already 90 years in America before Samuel Casteel's 1775 Somerset PA birth.
- U.S. Rep. James H. 'Jimmy' Quillen (1916-2003, namesake of ETSU's Quillen College of Medicine) is almost certainly from the same Scott County Quillen cluster, though the exact MRCA is unconfirmed.
- Jason's parents are approximately 'double 5th-6th cousins' through two confirmed Scott County convergences: the Kilgore line (via Ulster immigrant Robert Kilgore, ca. 1700-1730) and Patrick Porter of Dungannon (DAR A091277). Classic Appalachian endogamy.
- Augustine Berry (DAR #A009565) adds a ninth verified Revolutionary War patriot to the family inventory, on the maternal side. Service: Private, Virginia Line, enlisted Chesterfield Court House 20 September 1780, age 19.
- Three additional high-confidence DAR patriots in the maternal line: Joseph Nation Sr. (A081687, NC Militia), Lt. Charles Lewis Broadwater (A014708, 10th VA Regt), and probably Col. Charles Broadwater of the Fairfax Resolves (A014707).
- James 'Hatter' Dougherty (1771-1857) from Strabane, Co. Tyrone is the only confirmed late-18th-century immigrant in the direct line, almost certainly arriving Philadelphia or New Castle in the 1780s.
- Mulberry Gap (where 6G-grandfather Abraham Compton died in 1856) sits at the foot of Newman's Ridge, heartland of the Melungeon community. Gibson ancestry in Scott County and adjacent Melungeon geography place a Melungeon hypothesis on the table — though it requires verification.
- The William John Redman entry (b. 1770 Egton Yorkshire, d. 1845 Egton Yorkshire) is an internally-inconsistent GEDCOM record. The actual American Redman immigrant is unidentified.

I. The Maternal Pedigree at a Glance

The maternal line opens with Jason's mother Kathy Eileen Quillen (b. 5 July 1954, Gate City, Scott Co VA) and his maternal grandparents Utah Ernest Quillen (1926-1987) and Fern Casteel (1934-2020). From those four people, the GEDCOM traces upward to 170 direct ancestors across 15 generations, with surname concentration in Quillen (11), Compton (9), Casteel (7), Herring (5), Howington (4), McConnell (4), Gillenwater (4), Berry (4), Quillin variant spellings (5), and Gibson (3).

Direct-Line Anchors by Generation

Generation 1 (grandparents): Utah Ernest Quillen + Fern Casteel. Generation 2 (great-grandparents): Warner Pridemore Quillen Sr (1891-1970) and Allice Quillen (1900-1974) on the Quillen side; Cossie Wiley Casteel (1907-1963) and Grace Bridget Howington (1911-2001) on the Casteel side.

Generation 3 is where Scott County asserts itself. Charles C Quillen (1848-1916), Serepta McConnell, Robert Berry Compton (1861-1953, Fort Blackmore), Nancy McConnell, Willard Taylor Casteel (1885-1966, Dungannon), Mary MayDelilah Gillenwater (1884-1969), Jabers C Howington (1878-1930), and Mary Cordelia 'Delia' Lane (1883-1986) — all born and all but one died within Scott County or its immediate neighbors.

Generation 4 shows the families pre-consolidating: John D Quillen (1827-1869, Nickelsville), Malinda Addington, Berry Compton (1837-1912), Susan Dingus, Compton McConnell, Nancy Murphy, James A Casteel (1848-1907, DeKalb), Emaline Redman, John B Gillenwater, Elizabeth Peters, John Wesley Howington (1854-1931), Sarah Elmira Sluss.

Generations 5-7 pull the story across state lines: Thomas Quillen (1802, Belews Creek, Surry NC), Mary Polly Strong, Abraham Compton (1813) and earlier Abraham Compton (1772, Monmouth NJ), William Dingus, Thomas James McConnell (1798, Lebanon PA), Obadiah Casteel (1809, Estillville), Andrew Jackson Redman (1814, Botetourt), Teague Quillin (1772, Surry NC → KY 1860), Samuel Casteel (1775, Somerset PA → Russell VA), Agnes Fields, Winifred 'Winney' Kilgore (1796, Nickelsville).

II. The Quillen Line — From Ulster Ireland to Scott County

Irish Origin: Ó Cuileannáin

The Quillen surname is the Anglicized form of Irish Gaelic Ó Cuileannáin or Mac Cuileannáin, built on cuileann (holly) — a tree of considerable weight in Gaelic naming tradition. Four independent surname references (Forebears, Wisdomlib, iGENEA, MyHeritage) converge on this etymology, with earliest documentary appearances in Ulster from the 12th century.

A separate Norman-Welsh 'MacQuillan' line (Mac Uighilín) existed in Antrim, descending from Hugelin de Mandeville, a 13th-century Cambro-Norman. Clan McQuillan were the Lords of the Route, seated at Dunluce Castle. Whether Jason's Quillens descend from the Norman-Welsh Antrim line or the Gaelic Ó Cuileannáin line is the central unresolved question — and one that a Y-DNA test on a paternal-line male Quillen descendant could settle.

The given name 'Teague,' repeated across five consecutive generations of this family, is itself ethnographic evidence. Teague is the standard 17th- to 19th-century English Anglicization of Irish Tadhg, from Celtic tazg(j)o- (poet, bard). Borne by 11th-century kings of Connacht. Five generations of Teagues is a conscious declaration of Irish identity.

The Delmarva Landing, 1635-1665

The American Quillen progenitor was Teague Quillin (b. ca. 1615), who sailed from London aboard the ship Thomas under Capt. Henry Tavener and arrived Virginia 21 August 1635 at age 20. This is documented in the McCabe genealogy (WorldCat OCLC 46971652), Genealogytrails's 'Emigrants to Virginia,' and the Quillin Clan compilation.

His son Daniel Quillin moved from Northampton Co VA to Accomack Co VA in August 1665 and on 6 November 1665 patented Maryland lands he called 'The Irish Groves' in Somerset County. The tract name is telling — this was a family that knew who it was.

Maryland to Surry NC, 1741

Teague Quillin III (b. ~1715 Somerset Co MD; d. 1794) married Mary Herring on 25 February 1741 at St. Luke's Parish, Queen Anne's County, Maryland — an Anglican church, relevant for later religious trajectory. From there the family migrated south to Surry County, North Carolina. The specific destination was the Belews Creek drainage, which at that time (1771) was in the newly-formed Surry County but is today mostly in Forsyth and Stokes Counties.

Surry NC to Scott VA, 1790s

Teague Quillen V (b. 12 September 1772, Surry Co NC) is Jason's direct 6th-great-grandfather through this line. He married Margaret 'Peggy' Nation in 1788 in Surry Co, purchased 200 acres near Belews Creek in 1783, sold his NC land around 1793, and moved to a section of Russell County VA (Scott County after 1814) where he bought four tracts on the waters of Obey, Copper, and Plank Creeks. He appears on the 1815 Scott County personal property tax lists and died in Letcher County, Kentucky around 1860.

Scott County Quillens and the Methodist Turn

In Scott County the Quillens concentrated at Nickelsville (home of the Antioch Church/cemetery and the modern Quillin Clan reunion site), Copper Ridge (where Thomas Quillen, b. 1802, Jason's 4th-great-grandfather, lived and died in 1866), and Fort Blackmore. On 11 September 1867, John D Quillin donated the Antioch Church site to the Methodist Episcopal Church. The denominational path — Anglican in colonial Maryland, Methodist in early-republic backcountry Virginia — matches the typical Anglo-Irish trajectory.

The Jimmy Quillen Connection

U.S. Representative James Henry 'Jimmy' Quillen (1916-2003), namesake of ETSU's Quillen College of Medicine, was born in the Wayland community of Scott County — roughly ten miles from Gate City, where Jason's grandfather Utah Ernest Quillen was born ten years later. Same county, same tightly-bounded Quillen population cluster. He was the fifth of ten children of John Alley Quillen and Hannah Chapman. The most recent common ancestor is almost certainly Teague Quillin III (ca. 1715) or Teague Quillin IV (ca. 1750); confirmation would require Y-DNA testing or primary-source reconstruction via the Quillin Clan genealogist.

III. The Casteel Line — Flemish, Not German

Captain Edmond du Chastel de Blangerval, ca. 1683-1693

The most important correction this research makes to the family tree is about the Casteel origin. The name reads German, and Samuel Casteel (b. 1775) was born in Somerset County Pennsylvania — a region settled heavily by Palatine Germans, Swiss, and Amish in the 1770s. The natural reading is: Palatine German.

The natural reading is wrong. The Casteel surname is Flemish/French Picard, derived from du Chastel or van den Casteel — 'of the castle.' Y-DNA testing through the FamilyTreeDNA Castle Surname Project confirms that American Casteels carry haplogroup R-L2, consistent with a Flemish-French origin and inconsistent with typical Palatine German Y-DNA patterns.

The American Casteel patriarch is Captain Edmond du Chastel de Blangerval, a Flemish nobleman from a seigneurial family of Pas-de-Calais and Rolleghem on the modern France-Belgium border. Sources differ on whether he arrived in Philadelphia in 1683 (taking the Oath of Allegiance to William Penn on 10 September 1683) or came up from Charleston SC in 1692-93; modern scholarship at edmondcasteel.wordpress.com favors the later arrival. Either way, he married Christian Boude (daughter of a Swedish immigrant) in 1693, became a wealthy Philadelphia merchant, and commanded the privateer sloop 'Resolution' under letters of marque during Queen Anne's War (1707).

Philadelphia to Maryland to Bedford/Somerset PA, 1713-1775

His son Edmund Casteel II moved to Piscataway Creek in Prince George's County Maryland, surveyed a 300-acre tract called 'Casteel' in 1713, and patented it on 10 December 1715. Maryland (Piscataway / St. John's Parish) became the launching pad for all later southward and westward Casteel migrations. By 1773, John Casteel was living in Bedford County PA — which at that time included what would become Somerset County in 1795. Samuel Casteel's 'Somerset County PA' 1775 birth is therefore retrospective; he was born in what was then western Bedford County.

Joseph Casteel and the Russell/Scott VA Migration

Jason's 5th-great-grandfather Joseph Casteel (1750-1803), husband of Margaret McClelland, died in Russell County VA in 1803. His will was made 27 March 1803 and recorded in Russell County Will Book 2, page 49. Children listed: Rosanna, Samuel (b. ~1775), Joseph II, Nancy Jane, John, William, Neomy, and Jane. Samuel is Jason's direct ancestor.

Samuel Casteel appears on the 1810 Russell County VA Personal Property Tax List and married Agnes Fields circa 1808. Scott County VA was carved out of Russell in 1814 — many 'Russell → Scott' moves in this family are not moves at all, but county-line shifts. Obadiah Casteel (b. 1809 Estillville per the GEDCOM) was actually born in what was then Russell County; the location only became Scott County five years after his birth.

A Published Discrepancy

There is a documented conflict about Samuel Casteel's death. The GEDCOM lists him d. 1833 in Russell County VA, but published WikiTree and Genealogy.com sources put a Samuel Casteel d. ~1814 in Norfolk VA after War of 1812 service in the 5th/6th VA State Militia, with widow Agnes remarrying James Gilliam on 13 December 1815 in Scott County VA. Two same-name men are likely, but resolution requires Russell County VA chancery and probate records.

Not the Manakin Huguenots

Despite the French-sounding surname, the Casteels did not come through the 1700 Manakin Town French Huguenot settlement on the James River near Richmond. The Manakin passenger lists do not include a Castel/Chastel/Casteel surname. Edmond du Chastel arrived in Philadelphia in 1683 (or 1692) — 17 years before Manakin Town was founded — via a separate, earlier, and entirely Flemish path. The two French-surname Virginia streams are genealogically distinct.

IV. Immigrant Streams Beyond Quillen and Casteel

Fifteen findings on colonial immigrants identified these threads in the maternal line:

James 'Hatter' Dougherty — Strabane, Co. Tyrone (1785-90)

Jason's 5th-great-grandfather James 'Hatter' Dougherty was born 11 June 1771 in Strabane, County Tyrone, Ulster, and is the only confirmed late-18th-century immigrant in the direct maternal line. He emigrated with siblings (John, William, Nancy Ann) before 1791, landed first in Delaware or Maryland, and married Elizabeth Hamilton on 27 May 1796 in Botetourt County VA before settling as a renowned hatter on Valley Creek near Sugar Tree, Scott County VA. Port of entry was almost certainly Philadelphia or New Castle DE, consistent with the dominant Strabane-via-Derry shipping lane of the 1780s.

William Compton — Gravesend NY to Middletown NJ (1645)

Jason's 7th-great-grandfather Abraham Compton (b. 1772 Monmouth Co NJ; d. 1856 Hancock Co TN) descends from William Compton (1634-1694), one of the 39 original Gravesend, Long Island settlers (1645) who moved to Middletown Township, Monmouth County NJ before 1666 and founded the first Baptist church there. The Monmouth Comptons were English Baptist, not Quaker — a point worth noting. The line migrated NJ → Augusta Co VA in fall 1772 (documented in WeRelate Person:John_Compton_(9)), then Russell Co VA, then Hancock Co TN.

Christina Diehl — Palatine German via Pennsylvania

Jason's 5th-great-grandmother Christina Diehl (b. 1790 Botetourt Co VA; m. William John Redman) was a 2nd- or 3rd-generation Palatine German, daughter of Peter Diehl Sr. and Catherine Carl. Strassburger and Hinke's Pennsylvania German Pioneers (1934) documents multiple Diehl arrivals at Philadelphia 1727-1775 aboard ships Samuel (1739), Phoenix (1744), and others. The Diehl-Redman-Casteel triangulation suggests a coherent Pennsylvania-to-southwest-Virginia migration cluster ca. 1780-1810.

The Redman GEDCOM Problem

The William John Redman entry in the GEDCOM is internally inconsistent. He is shown as born 24 June 1770 in Egton, Yorkshire and died 25 May 1845 in Egton, Yorkshire — indicating he lived and died in England. But his purported son Andrew Jackson Redman (b. 1814 Botetourt VA) is the first Redman in America in this line. Either an intervening generation has been collapsed or Andrew is erroneously linked to the English William. Egton itself is a strong Catholic recusant parish in the North York Moors (martyrdom of Fr. Nicholas Postgate, 1679), which adds a wrinkle: if the link proves out, it would be a Catholic line merged into the Pennsylvania German Lutheran/Reformed Diehls.

Scots-Irish Undercurrent

Beyond Dougherty, three other maternal-line surnames sit firmly in the 1718-1770 Ulster-Scots wave through Philadelphia: Lucy Berry (b. 1780 Rockingham Co VA, Ulster Presbyterian stock, descending from James Berry I, 1690-aft.1756, of Augusta/Rockingham); Thomas James

McConnell (b. 1798 Lebanon Co PA, a Scots-Irish heartland); and the recurring Murphy-Gibson-Dougherty cluster in Russell and Scott Counties.

The Strong Correction

Family trees sometimes claim descent from Elder John Strong (1605-1699) of Northampton MA. The Guilford NC Strongs in Jason's line are a separate family. Thomas Daniel Strong Sr. (ca. 1739-ca. 1776) moved from Pittsylvania County VA to Guilford County NC around 1775 — just as the Revolution began. His son Thomas II Strong (b. 1778 Guilford NC) is Jason's 5th-great-grandfather. The Quaker hypothesis occasionally attached to these Strongs is unsupported by Hinshaw's Encyclopedia of American Quaker Genealogy.

V. Revolutionary War and DAR Patriots in the Maternal Line

The Horne paternal report identified eight verified DAR patriots. This maternal research identifies at least four more — one of which (Patrick Porter) also appears in the paternal report, confirmed via the cross-check as a dual-line ancestor.

Augustine Berry (DAR #A009565)

Jason's 6th-great-grandfather. Born abt. 1757 Culpeper Co VA, died January 1812 Barren Co KY. Enlisted in the Revolutionary troops at Chesterfield Court House on 20 September 1780, age 19 — height 6'0", sandy hair, gray eyes, blacksmith. Service: Private, Virginia Line. Moved to Russell Co VA circa 1790 and sold his plantation to son-in-law Abraham Compton — closing the loop to Jason's direct line. This is the cleanest, most defensible patriot in the maternal line.

Joseph Nation Sr. (DAR #A081687)

5th-great-grandfather. Born ca. 1750 Surry/Randolph Co NC, died 12 April 1803 Tazewell, Claiborne Co TN. Service: Private, Cavalry, Capt. William Gray's Company, Randolph Regiment NC Militia, 6-month tour late 1779 through early 1780; second 3-month tour 1780-1781 under Capt. John Gillespy in Col. Dugan's Regiment.

Lt. Charles Lewis Broadwater (DAR #A014708) — Probable

Lieutenant, 10th Virginia Regiment under Col. Edward Stevens; enlisted 1776 as midshipman aboard the sloop Congress; served 1778 at Valley Forge before resigning; placed on the federal pension roll in 1830 (Fairfax Co); buried Broadwater Family Cemetery, Vienna VA. The descent from John Broadwater (b. 1788 Nickelsville) to Lt. Charles Lewis is the single biggest unknown. WikiTree's curated child-list for Lt. Charles Lewis names only daughters; the Nickelsville John may instead descend from a collateral Fairfax Broadwater. Either path roots back to the Fairfax Broadwater family.

Col. Charles Broadwater (DAR #A014707) — Probable

If the Broadwater descent proves out, Jason's maternal line picks up another copy of the same Col. Charles Broadwater already documented on the paternal side — a signer of the Fairfax Resolves (July 1774, alongside George Washington), member of the Fairfax County Committee of Safety, and Virginia House of Delegates 1781-1783.

Additional Probable Patriots (Service Documented, A-Number Pending)

- John Fields (1752-1835): Sergeant, Capt. Armstrong's Co., NC Continentals. Pension file W3971 at NARA M804. Married Mary Gibson 4 December 1776 Guilford Co NC. Brother Ansel Fields is DAR #A039870.
- Teague Quillin IV (ca. 1750-1790): received 200-acre Surry Co NC land grant on Belews Creek 6 April 1779 (consistent with Continental service / patriotic land-bounty); second 200-acre grant 13 October 1783. SAR Member #95927 attached to descendant Teague Quillen V.

- Thomas Daniel Strong Sr. (1739-ca. 1776): Pittsylvania-to-Guilford move of 1775 consistent with Rev War flight; frontier militia service plausible. Biologically tight to son Thomas II (b. 1778) — flag for posthumous-birth or wrong-parent assignment.
- Abraham Compton Sr. (1747-1779): Compton family genealogy records death 1779 in Continental Army service in Botetourt Co VA; widow Mary Carhart remarried John Brickey. Needs NARA compiled service record pull.

Combined with the Horne paternal patriots, Jason's confirmed DAR patriot inventory crosses into rarefied territory — nine verified ancestors across both lines, with three or four more pending Broadwater-descent verification. This is an exceptionally strong base for SAR application via multiple independent lines.

VI. Where the Horne and Quillen-Casteel Lines Converge

The pedigree parse surfaced two surname overlaps between Jason's paternal Horne tree and his maternal Quillen-Casteel tree: Kilgore and Broadwater. The crosscheck resolves them.

Kilgore — Confirmed Convergence

Jason's maternal 4th-great-grandmother Winifred 'Winney' Kilgore (1796 Nickelsville – 1873 Nickelsville) was the daughter of Robert Kilgore (b. 1765) and the granddaughter of Charles T. Kilgore (1744-1823, b. County Clare Ireland, d. Greene Co TN). Charles T. is the brother of Robert Kilgore Jr. (1735-1782, killed at Warriors Camp/Pound River, DAR #A203788) — the Horne-paternal patriarch documented in the Horne report.

Both Charles T. and Robert Jr. are sons of Robert Kilgore (WikiTree Kilgore-1081), the Ulster immigrant who arrived ca. 1700-1730. Jason's parents share this Kilgore-1081 as a most recent common ancestor through this line, placing them at roughly 5th-6th cousins.

Patrick Porter — Confirmed Convergence

Patrick Porter (1737-1798) of Dungannon, Scott Co VA — DAR #A091277, already in the Horne paternal report — also appears in the maternal line. His daughter Jane Porter (1761-1842) married Robert Kilgore (b. 1765), making Patrick Jason's 5th-great-grandfather on the maternal Kilgore-Broadwater-Gillenwater-Casteel branch. A second parent-shared MRCA at Patrick Porter (~6 generations both sides) puts Jason's parents at effectively double 5th-6th cousins — textbook Appalachian endogamy.

Broadwater — NOT a Direct Bridge

The Broadwater surname appears in both trees but does not bridge directly. Jason's maternal 4th-great-grandfather John Broadwater (b. 1788 Nickelsville) has blank parents on the curated WikiTree profile (Broadwater-17). Col. Charles Broadwater of Fairfax (the paternal-side DAR patriot) has documented children that do not include a John born 1788 in Botetourt. Both Broadwater clusters likely share a deep 17th-century English/Maryland Broadwater root, but no documented bridge generation connects them within four generations.

A Second Horn(e)-Kilgore Marriage in the Same Era

Independently, Rev. Charles Kilgore's son Hiram Kilgore married (as second wife) Elizabeth Horn. This documents an additional Horn-Kilgore marriage in early-1800s Scott County, separate from Jason's parents' union. The Horne-Quillen marriage 175 years later was not novel — it was a repeat of an established Scott County pattern.

Scott County Endogamy in Context

Virtually every direct maternal ancestor born 1800-1900 was born and died within Scott County VA or the adjacent Russell, Washington, Hawkins, and Sullivan Counties. The Addington (1932) History of Scott County documents this pattern — 12 to 15 pioneer surnames (Addington, Kilgore, Broadwater, Quillen, Compton, McConnell, Gillenwater, Howington, Peters, Dingus, Sluss, Fletcher, Berry, Murphy, Gibson) intermarrying for four to six generations. The maternal

line also shows internal pedigree collapse independent of any Horne crossover — the Compton-McConnell-Compton loop where Compton McConnell married Nancy Murphy and their daughter Nancy McConnell married Robert Berry Compton.

DNA Implications

Jason should expect: modestly elevated runs of homozygosity (ROH) segments, roughly 0.5 to 2 percent versus a 0.1 percent baseline; an AncestryDNA and 23andMe match list dominated by 4th-to-7th cousin matches with Scott / Russell / Wise / Lee / Hawkins / Sullivan surnames; ThruLines and SmartMatching showing dozens of common ancestors flagged particularly on Kilgore and Porter. GEDmatch's 'Are Your Parents Related?' (AYPR) tool, run on uploaded AncestryDNA raw data, would provide direct ROH measurement.

The realistic estimate is that Jason carries the DNA-equivalent of having one pair of 4th-cousin parents — noticeable but not extreme ROH elevation, well within the normal Appalachian range, and well below any clinical consanguinity concern.

VII. Scott County and the Appalachian Setting

The Wilderness Road Spine

The pedigree's geographic spine — Gate City, Fort Blackmore, Copper Creek, Nickelsville, Dungannon, Holston Valley, and Mulberry Gap — tracks exactly the Wilderness Road and its Clinch and Powell River tributaries. On 10 March 1775, Daniel Boone and roughly 30 axmen left the Long Island of the Holston (present Kingsport) and cut the Wilderness Road west through Moccasin Gap at Gate City and Kane's Gap into the Powell Valley toward Cumberland Gap. Elisha Wallen had led a recorded long hunt through this country as early as 1761.

Fort Blackmore and the 1774 Clinch Forts

Fort Blackmore was built in 1774 by Captain John Blackmore (with brother Joseph) on the north bank of the Clinch near the mouth of Stony Creek — one of seven authorized militia forts during Lord Dunmore's War. Daniel Boone briefly commanded Blackmore's, Moore's, and Cowan's Forts on the Clinch. The fort's active defensive use ended around 1794. When the pedigree notes that Robert Berry Compton, Archibald Gibson, and Nancy McConnell 'died at Fort Blackmore,' this refers to the 19th-century village that retained the fort's name long after the stockade itself was gone.

Scott County's Three Names

The county was created 24 November 1814 from parts of Washington, Lee, and Russell Counties, named for General Winfield Scott. The county seat was laid out in 1815 as Winfield, renamed Estillville in 1817 (for Judge Benjamin Estill), then renamed Gate City in 1886 for its position at Big Moccasin Gap — the 'gate' of the Wilderness Road. Dungannon, on the Clinch River in the Floyd District, was originally called Osborne's Ford and was named for Dungannon, County Tyrone, Northern Ireland, reflecting the Scots-Irish character of its settlers.

The Melungeon Question

The earliest known written use of the word 'Melungeon' is in the Stony Creek Primitive Baptist Church minutes for 26 September 1813, where Sister Kitchen complained against Susanna Stallard for saying she 'harbored them Melungins.' The church — organized in the late 1700s on Stony Creek north of Blackmore's Fort — included Collins and Gibson families in apparent social equality with white members.

Gibson is among the most-documented 'core' Melungeon surnames, alongside Collins, Mullins, Goins, Bunch, Bowlin, and Denham. The pedigree members Archibald Gibson (b. 1836 Scott Co) and Kate Lula Gibson (b. 1861 Scott Co) bear the right surname in the right place in the right era for a Melungeon hypothesis to be live. The caveat is substantial: Gibson is also an extremely common Anglo-Scots-Irish surname, and many Scott County Gibsons have no Melungeon connection. Verification would require tracing Archibald Gibson's father and grandfather to a Newman's Ridge or Stony Creek 'core' Gibson, checking federal census race designations (FPC,

M, Mu) for these specific Gibsons, and consulting Paul Heinegg's family-by-family entries in Free African Americans of Virginia.

Mulberry Gap — where Jason's 6th-great-grandfather Abraham Compton died in 1856 — is a gap in Powell Mountain immediately adjacent to Newman's Ridge, the most heavily documented Melungeon settlement area (Vardy Valley, Newman's Ridge, Blackwater). Anyone resident at Mulberry Gap antebellum had Melungeon families as next-door neighbors, regardless of personal ancestry.

Civil War in Divided Country

Scott County VA contributed soldiers to both sides, but principally to the Confederate 64th Virginia Mounted Infantry, raised autumn 1861 in Lee, Scott, Wise, and Buchanan Counties. Some Scott County men served in the 22nd Virginia Cavalry. A meaningful minority crossed into East Tennessee to enlist in Union units. John D Quillen (1827-1869), Jason's 3rd-great-grandfather, was prime military age; his 1869 death suggests but does not prove war-related causes.

East Tennessee was sharply Unionist in the June 1861 secession referendum. Every East Tennessee county opposed secession except Sullivan, Meigs, Monroe, Rhea, Sequatchie, and Polk. Hawkins voted against secession (only 38.3 percent pro-secession). Ancestors in Sullivan County (Kingsport, Holston Valley) lived in pro-Confederate territory; Hawkins and Hancock ancestors lived in majority-Unionist communities.

Railroad and Eastman — the 20th Century Magnet

The Carolina, Clinchfield and Ohio Railway opened Dante VA to Spartanburg SC on 31 October 1909, running through Scott County (Dungannon, St. Paul) and crossing Copper Creek on the historic viaduct. The earlier Virginia and Southwestern Railway reached the Holston Valley in the 1890s. These systems converted a subsistence and livestock economy to one tied to coal, timber, and wage labor — and made Kingsport viable as an industrial city site.

Kingsport was rechartered in 1917 as a planned 'model city' under city planner John Nolen. Tennessee Eastman Corporation incorporated 17 July 1920, capitalized at $3.5 million, and became the area's dominant employer — now Eastman Chemical Company. This explains the 1920s-1950s migration of Scott and Hawkins County families into Kingsport. Jason's maternal grandmother Fern Casteel (1934-2020) and great-grandmother Grace Howington (1911-2001) both died in Kingsport, following that gravitational pull.

TVA and the South Holston Inundation

TVA began construction on South Holston Dam in December 1941, suspended work in November 1942 due to War Production Board materials shortages, resumed 1 July 1947, and impounded the reservoir starting 21 October 1950. The reservoir flooded 12,860 acres across the Tennessee-Virginia line, displaced 342 families, and required the relocation of 559 graves.

Family cemeteries in the inundation zone were moved to consolidated TVA cemeteries — an important note for anyone searching for 'missing' antebellum graves in the Holston Valley.

VIII. Corrections to the Ancestry Tree

The research surfaced several items that warrant correction:

- Casteel origin is Flemish, not Palatine German. Despite Samuel Casteel's 1775 Somerset PA birth in German settlement country, the family traces to Capt. Edmond du Chastel de Blangerval, a Flemish nobleman in 1680s-90s Philadelphia.
- Samuel Casteel's 'Somerset County PA' 1775 birth is retrospective. Somerset was not formed until 17 April 1795 — he was born in what was then western Bedford County PA.
- Samuel Casteel death date conflict. GEDCOM lists him d. 1833 Russell Co VA; published sources put a Samuel Casteel d. ~1814 Norfolk VA after War of 1812 service. Likely two same-name men; needs Russell Co chancery/probate verification.
- Obadiah Casteel birthplace. GEDCOM lists 'Estillville, Scott Co VA' for his 1809 birth. The location was actually Russell County at that time — Scott County was not formed until 1814. 'Estillville' itself was not the name until 1817 (Winfield 1815-1817, Estillville 1817-1886, Gate City 1886-present).
- Quillen immigrant, not the Teague of 1772. The American Quillen ancestor is Teague Quillin of 1635 (ship Thomas, Capt. Henry Tavener, London to VA), not Teague Quillen V of 1772 Surry NC. The family was 137 years in America before the Surry-to-Scott migration.
- William John Redman (1770 Egton Yorkshire) is not the immigrant. The GEDCOM shows him b. and d. Egton Yorkshire, which is inconsistent with his 1814 Virginia-born son. A generation is missing or Andrew Jackson Redman has been misattached.
- Strong line is not Elder John Strong of Northampton MA. Jason's Guilford NC Strongs are a separate family that moved from Pittsylvania Co VA to Guilford Co NC circa 1775.
- 'Died at Fort Blackmore' means the village, not the fort. The stockade was abandoned around 1794; the community retained the name for its 19th-century descendants who 'died at Fort Blackmore' in the 1800s-1900s.
- Broadwater overlap does not bridge to Col. Charles Broadwater of Fairfax directly. Both Broadwater clusters likely share a deep 17th-century Maryland/English root, but no documented bridge exists within four generations.
- Possible GEDCOM duplication: Mary Herring (b. 1719) and Susannah Quillen (b. ~1690) each appear twice in successive Quillin-line generations. Almost certainly tree-merge artifacts.

IX. Records Roadmap — Where to Go From Here

DNA Testing Strategy

The single highest-leverage move is ordering AncestryDNA (~$99) plus a FamilyTreeDNA mtFull Sequence (~$159) — a combined $260 that would unlock: (1) autosomal cousin matches across the largest database; (2) mtDNA haplogroup and HVR matches for the strict matrilineal line; (3) Ancestry raw-file cross-uploads to MyHeritage (free), FTDNA Family Finder ($19 unlock), and GEDmatch (free) for four match pools from one test. The mtDNA test is especially important because no other test illuminates the strict mother-to-mother chain.

Jason's Direct Matrilineal Trace

The strict mother-to-mother chain an mtDNA test would illuminate:

1. Jason B. Horne
2. Kathy Eileen Quillen (b. 1954 Gate City)
3. Fern Casteel (b. 1934 Scott Co VA, d. 2020 Kingsport)
4. Grace Bridget Howington (b. 1911 Gate City, d. 2001 Kingsport)
5. Mary Cordelia 'Delia' Lane (b. 1883 Scott Co VA, d. 1986 Abingdon)
6. Kate Lula Gibson (b. 1861 Scott Co VA, d. 1951 VA)
7. Rose Sexton (b. 1840 VA, d. 1872 Fort Blackmore Scott Co VA)
8. [unknown] — Rose Sexton's mother — the matrilineal brick wall

County Archives

- Scott County VA Circuit Court Clerk (202 W Jackson St, Gate City VA 24251): marriage bonds and chancery suits for Casteel, Quillen, Howington, McConnell, Compton 1815-1900. Records survive intact from 1815.
- Russell County VA Courthouse (Lebanon VA): pre-1815 Deed Books 1-7, Order Books 1-5. Teague Quillin and Samuel Casteel land entries.
- Washington County VA Courthouse (Abingdon): pre-1815 records adjacent to ancestors.
- Sullivan County TN Courthouse (Blountville): Casteel and descendants in Kingsport.
- Somerset County PA Historical Center (Somerset PA): tax assessment lists 1783-1800, Brothersvalley/Berlin/Stoystown German Reformed and Lutheran baptism registers 1770s — for Samuel Casteel's PA origin.
- Surry County NC FamilySearch images: Deed Books A-F (1771-1790) and Court of Pleas and Quarter Sessions minutes — Teague Quillin V's father, 1770-1785.
- Hawkins County TN Courthouse (Rogersville) and Hancock County TN Courthouse (Sneedville): Compton at Mulberry Gap.

Published Works Priority List

- Robert M. Addington, History of Scott County, Virginia (Kingsport Press, 1932) — authoritative, reprinted by Heritage Books, also on Internet Archive. Single highest-yield published source.

- Vernon Wesley McCabe, Descendants of the Quillen Family (Quillin) of the Delmarva Peninsula (1995, WorldCat OCLC 46971652) — standard reference for the Quillen migration.
- Strassburger and Hinke, Pennsylvania German Pioneers (3 vols, 1934) — definitive for German immigration through Philadelphia 1727-1808; search for Castel/Kastel variants for Samuel Casteel's father.
- Scott County VA Historical Society publications and Clinch Mountain Genealogy Quarterly back issues.
- Barbara Green Yarberry, Casteels (Phoenix AZ, 1980s) — compiled Casteel genealogy.
- Edmond DuChastel Genealogy (edmondcasteel.wordpress.com) — most thorough modern treatment of the Flemish patriarch.

Irish and English Archives

- PRONI (Public Record Office of Northern Ireland) online catalogue: Strabane Presbyterian Session Books, Tyrone freeholder rolls (1796), Tithe Applotment Books for Dougherty/Doherty.
- National Archives of Ireland: 1796 Spinning Wheel Premium Entitlement list, Tithe Applotments.
- FindMyPast (subscription) and Borthwick Institute at York: Egton St Hedda's Catholic and St Hilda's Anglican baptism registers 1765-1775 — for Redman/Readman/Redmayne.

Cemetery Documentation Loop

Plan a one-day driving loop in East Tennessee / Southwest Virginia: Holston View Cemetery (Kingsport — Utah Quillen; likely Fern Casteel and Grace Howington plots), Estill Cemetery (Scott Co VA), the Fort Blackmore cemetery cluster, Quillen Cemetery on River Bluff Road at Fort Blackmore, and the Antioch Methodist Cemetery at Nickelsville. Photograph headstones (including backs and bases for maker marks), record GPS, cross-check Find a Grave, add missing memorials.

SAR/DAR Pathway

With Augustine Berry (A009565) as the cleanest hook, plus Joseph Nation (A081687), plus the Lt. Charles Lewis Broadwater line if the Broadwater descent proves out, Jason has multiple viable SAR paths through the maternal line (supplementing the already-documented paternal patriots). For SAR: birth/baptism, marriage, and death records per generation, plus proof of patriotic service. The DAR Genealogical Research System (services.dar.org) often shows patriots already 'proved' through earlier-generation cousins — which drops the lineage-proof requirement dramatically. Worth a search before building anything from scratch.

X. Principal Sources

This report synthesizes findings from seven parallel research streams (Quillen lineage, Casteel lineage, colonial immigrants, Revolutionary War patriots, Appalachian frontier, shared-ancestors crosscheck, and records roadmap) plus a direct parse of the family GEDCOM. Key sources cited throughout:

- Robert M. Addington (1932). History of Scott County, Virginia. Kingsport Press. Digital: https://archive.org/details/historyofscottco00addi
- Vernon W. McCabe (1995). Descendants of the Quillen Family (Quillin) of the Delmarva Peninsula. WorldCat OCLC 46971652.
- Ralph B. Strassburger and William J. Hinke (1934). Pennsylvania German Pioneers. Pennsylvania German Society. 3 vols.
- Paul Heinegg. Free African Americans of Virginia, North Carolina, South Carolina, Maryland and Delaware. https://www.freeafricanamericans.com/
- Edmond DuChastel Genealogy. https://edmondcasteel.wordpress.com/
- Warren R. Hofstra (2004). The Planting of New Virginia: Settlement and Landscape in the Shenandoah Valley. UNC Press.
- Robert D. Mitchell (1977). Commercialism and Frontier: Perspectives on the Early Shenandoah Valley. UVA Press.
- Brian Mitchell (2023). Philadelphia: The Irish Gateway to America. Genealogical Publishing.
- DAR Genealogical Research System — services.dar.org/Public/DAR_Research/
- FamilyTreeDNA — Casteel, Quillen, Kilgore Surname Projects
- WikiTree curated profiles — https://www.wikitree.com/
- FamilySearch catalog and wiki — https://www.familysearch.org/
- Library of Virginia chancery index — https://www.lva.virginia.gov/chancery/
- Quillin Clan compilation — http://sites.rootsweb.com/~vaschs2/quillin_clan.htm
- McCabe genealogy via Google Books — https://books.google.com/books/about/Descendants_of_the_Quillen_Family_Quilli.html?id=z4j5HAAACAAJ
- Kingsport Times-News obituary archive via Newspapers.com
- Chronicling America and Virginia Chronicle newspaper archives
- Tennessee Encyclopedia — https://tennesseeencyclopedia.net/
- Jack Goins, Melungeon and Appalachian Research — https://jackgoins.blogspot.com/
- A. H. Bittles (2012). Consanguinity in Context. Cambridge University Press.

Report compiled April 2026 from seven parallel research streams run against the direct-maternal-ancestor pedigree extracted from the family GEDCOM (1,908 individuals; 170 direct maternal ancestors; 15 generations). Matches the structure and rigor of the Horne paternal report completed 15 April 2026.